

GAME WORKING TITLE: The Other Mother

The game 'The Other Mother' is a Hide-And-Seek horror game based on the hit stop motion horror movie, Coraline. You play as Coraline, trapped in a distorted version of her home, the Other World, ruled by the sinister Other Mother.

Armed with nothing but courage and quick thinking, Coraline must sneak through the house, hide from her evil 'Other Mother', and find a way to escape through the back door before time runs out. Use stealth to evade detection, crouch behind furniture to stay hidden, and avoid the Other Mother's gaze at all costs.

GAME SETUP/WHY ARE WE PLAYING?

We play because the game taps into a primal fear: the fear of being watched and hunted by someone, no, something that pretends to love you. The experience is intimate, driven by curiosity and unease. Each level is simple cat and mouse, with a door at the end of the level beyond the Other Mother. Every step deeper into the house reveals more about this strange Other World, and perhaps of the true intention of the Other Mother and Coraline's place in all this.

Unique Mechanic(s)

The main Unique Mechanic is the Other Mother's ability to see Coraline and to chase her. The Other Mother AI is run by Scripts and NavMesh, which allows a map of the floor to be preset for the AI to traverse. In addition, there are several Waypoints for the Other Mother to walk to in her search for Coraline.

The second part of this Mechanic is Coraline's ability to Crouch behind certain structures by pressing 'E'. When she does this, she evades the sight of the Other Mother completely, and remains undetected. The player knows they're hiding when they go into select transparent zones, crouch, and the message 'Hidden' appears in the top right of the screen. Conversely, they will know if they are seen if the message 'Seen!' appears in the screen's top right, as the Other Mother begins to chase the player at a much higher speed.

Layout(How many levels?)

The game will be designed around three core levels, each representing a deeper layer of the mirror world:

1. Level 1: The Living Room Maze: An introduction to movement, hiding, and AI detection.
2. Level 2: The Garden Scene: Introduces other characters and a more complex map.

- Level 3: The Mirror Hallway: Introduces reflective mirrors, where the Other Mother can see around objects and there are less safe zones. Also introduces a second antagonist: The Other Father.

Each level grows more distorted, using environmental storytelling to blur the line between the real and reflected worlds.

VIBE CHECK/IMAGES

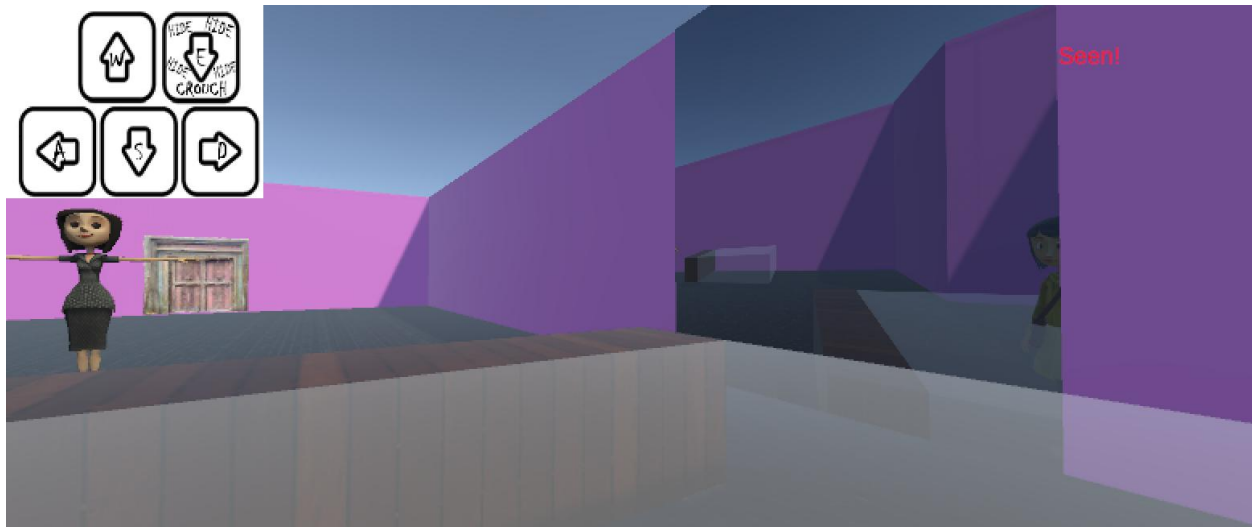


Image 1: Although Coraline is in the transparent zone, because she is not crouching, she is able to be seen and is being chased, quite relentlessly.

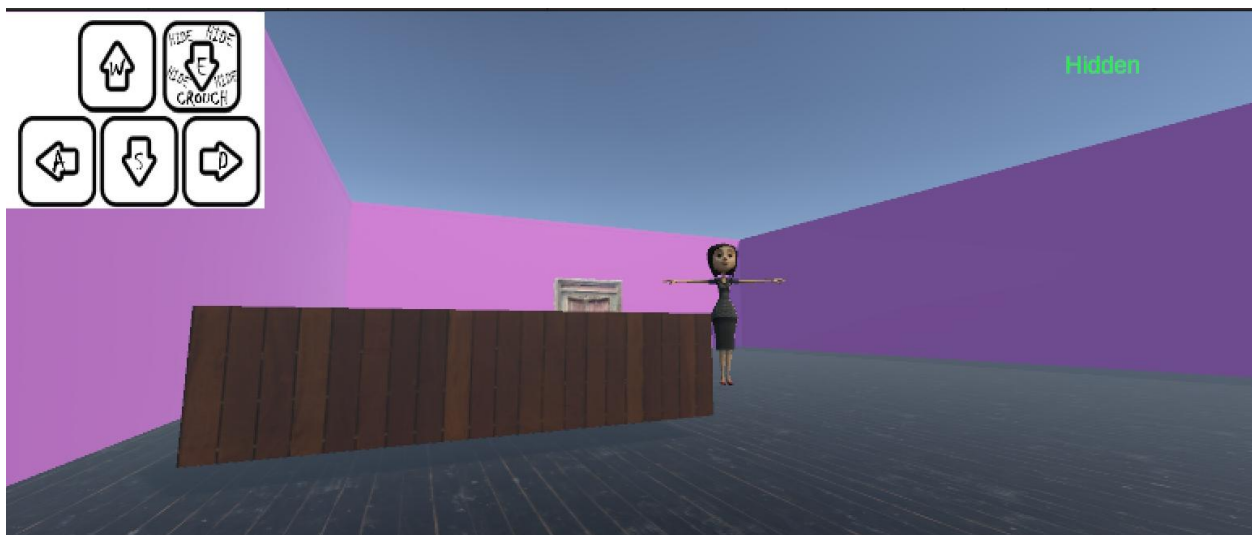


Image 2: Coraline is crouching behind a wall inside a transparent hidden zone, and thus, the Other Mother is not chasing her, even when looking in her direction.



Image 3: The Other Mother has collided with Coraline, triggering a 3s 'You Lose!!!' screen before restarting the level.



Image 4: Coraline has collided with the door, triggering the 'You Win!' screen, which will play for 3s before launching her into Scene 2.

NICE TO HAVE

Future versions could include voice acting, additional AI personalities (e.g., the Other Father), and clickable dialogue to interact with NPCs. Environmental puzzles, such as gathering a key for the door to open, could also add depth.

UI

The UI is intentionally minimal to preserve immersion. A small corner status notifier shows Coraline's visibility: **Hidden** when safe, **Seen!** when the Other Mother is aware. There is also a legend on the left hand side, showing the WASD keys for forward, left, backward, and right, as well as the oh-so-special 'E' key, which I detailed with a horror aesthetic saying 'hide' in twisted font.

The end screen uses cinematic fades for "You Win" and "You Lose," enhancing mood over text clutter. If options are implemented to 'talk' with AI and to pick up a key during a level, those will prompt dialogue and text pop-ups as well in the UI.

AUDIO

The soundtrack will feature creepy horror music, perhaps distant lullabies in reverse and slowed down. The Other Mother's proximity will trigger certain calls from the movies, such as the motherly, 'Coooooraline... where are you?' Creaky footsteps will also be heard on behalf of Coraline and the Other Mother.

I have Splice, so I may import horror SFX in addition to sounds from the movie. There will be trumpets perhaps for the win state, a scream or evil laugh for the lose state, and perhaps heartbeat sounds when being chased, as well as tense violin.

DEVELOPMENT ROADMAP

PLATFORM: Windows 64-bit executable game build

AUDIENCE: Focus demographics: Teen + & Adults who can't move on from fine art

1. **Milestone 1: Proof Of Concept/Core Mechanics Phase Polished:** Player movement, crouching, hiding, AI pathfinding, and mirror camera setup. Main functionality is currently completed, but more mechanics may be added.
2. **Milestone 2: Level 1 [Living Room] Polished:** Add sound design and key finding feature. Add letter to read about story
3. **Milestone 3: Level 2 [Garden] Polished:** Add sound design, key finding, and AI chats
4. **Milestone 4: Level 3 [Mirror Hallway] Polished:** Add sound design, key finding, and Other Father
5. **Milestone 5:** Optimize .exe build

Current Model Sources:

Other Mother: [Popular 3D models - Sketchfab](#)

Coraline: [Popular 3D models - Sketchfab](#)

Door: [Coraline house - A 3D model collection by Maleficent.wiccan - Sketchfab](#)

Wood Textures: https://polyhaven.com/a/black_painted_planks

https://polyhaven.com/a/plank_flooring_04

Key: [Magic Key - Download Free 3D model by unfu \(@unfu\) \[bd55b39\]](#)

Sconce: [Copper wall sconce - Download Free 3D model by IssisEstrada \(@IssisEstrada\) \[069fe37\]](#)